

Big butts

When trees grow in shallow soil, such as in rainforests, their roots might grow above the surface of the ground. These are buttress roots, which keep the tree stable. Some can grow to 4.5 m (15 ft) tall.

GRASS ROOTS

In 1937, an American scientist called Howard Dittmer studied the roots of a rye grass plant. The plant was just 50 cm (20 in) tall, and had 80 shoots. But it had more than 620 km (380 miles) of roots! They could cover an area of 237 sq m (2,554 sq ft), enough to carpet a large house. And this doesn't include the 14 billion root hairs!

